

LONDON • SCOTLAND • 2026



**BLESSED WITH
THIS TIME TOGETHER**

A CONRAD FAMILY JOURNEY
Through London & Scotland

SEPTEMBER 2026

BLESSED WITH THIS TIME TOGETHER

LONDON
SCOTLAND
2026

A NOTE FROM DAD

BEFORE WE GO

The four of us are together, and this trip is finally real. Read these pages whenever you find a quiet stretch. No one needs to read them aloud. Take your time, pause wherever you want and know that nothing needs to be said when you finish.

A few years ago, during one of our family trips to Lake of the Ozarks, we stopped at Lake Burger. After dinner, we brought our boozy dessert drinks back onto the boat, and Jay set his milkshake on the floor. While we were crossing the water, he flailed around in his seat and smashed his toe directly into it.

There was no mystery to solve. The milkshake was on the floor. Jay's foot moved. The two met exactly as anyone familiar with feet and gravity might have predicted.

Before the rest of us had fully processed what happened, Kea named it the Toe Shake.

Most people would consider that the end of the milkshake. Jay did not. He drank the entire thing anyway.

That was the beginning of another Conrad family story. Jay contributed the toe - and then demonstrated an unexpected commitment to finishing what he started. Kea handled the branding. The rest of us have kept the story alive far longer than Jay probably believes was necessary.

That is usually how our best memories happen. They are rarely the moments we plan perfectly. They are the strange comments, wrong turns, uncontrollable laughter and completely unnecessary arguments that become funnier once everyone has eaten. They would mean almost nothing to anyone outside our family and everything to us.

London and Scotland will give us incredible places to see, history to experience, golf to appreciate and a football game none of us will ever forget. But the places are only part of why this trip matters.

What matters most is that the four of us will be there together - with time to laugh, talk and add new stories to the ones that already belong only to us. Years from now, I hope that is what we remember most.



ELEVEN DAYS TOGETHER

WHY THIS TRIP MATTERS

We do not get as much time together as we used to. That is nobody's fault. You guys have built careers and lives with real responsibilities. Mom and I have our own schedules. We still see each other, talk often and share plenty of good times, but finding an opportunity for all four of us to step away from everything else has become harder.

When you were young, family time was simply built into life. There were practices, games, school, car rides, golf, bowling, weekends on the boat and vacations at the lake. At the time, much of it felt ordinary. Looking back, ordinary was the gift. We did not need to coordinate four adult calendars just to sit at the same table.

This trip gives us something rare now: eleven days together. For the first time, we are going overseas as a family. We will experience London's history, walk through places we have heard about our entire lives, play golf where the game grew up and stand together at St Andrews. We will celebrate a birthday, eat well, see Wembley and probably debate several things that do not require debate.

Kea and I will almost certainly attempt to manage something at the same time, with both of us convinced we know the exact right way to do it. Jay will offer a sarcastic observation from a reasonably safe distance. Mom will wonder why any of it required so much discussion and somehow get us moving again. This is the system that has kept our family operational for years.

A lot of work went into getting us here. There were spreadsheets, flight changes, research, opinions and enough planning conversations to make the trip feel like a small corporate merger. Kea turned countless possibilities into an organized plan. Mom handled flight changes and brought the steady judgment she brings to nearly everything. Jay helped organize details and gave honest feedback. Every one of us helped shape this trip before we packed a bag.

Now that the trip is here, none of that work needs a scoreboard. What matters is that it gave the four of us this time together. We get to stop planning it and start living it.



THE PEOPLE I GET TO SHARE THIS WITH

MOM

Mom, our story started at Arizona State University 30 years ago, when you showed me the model at the Commons on Apache. One of your coworkers took one look at me and told you that you were going to marry me — I'm assuming purely on looks, since she hadn't heard me say a word yet. She should've played the lottery that day. Two years later, we were married at Treasure Island in Las Vegas.

We were still broke as hell back then, so we'd drive to Vegas for \$25 nights at Bally's, gamble like we had a real budget to protect, spend most of the day at the pool since that part was free, and splurge on one drink each like we were high rollers. Then we'd go blow the rest of what little we had left on dinner at Battista's Hole in the Wall like we were the only two people in the world who knew about it. We didn't have a pot to piss in, but we had everything that mattered.

You have been the steady center of this family for as long as we have been one. You have quietly made yourself responsible for every task the rest of us would rather pretend didn't exist. You shovel our own driveway every winter while I spend the whole season making sure everyone else's is done first. During the College World Series, you handled the kids' gear shopping every year while I was busy handling a cooler with your family. You take care of the bulk of the Christmas shopping so I never have to experience a mall in December, an arrangement I consider one of the great unspoken gifts of our marriage. I don't say thank you for any of it nearly enough.



THE PEOPLE I GET TO SHARE THIS WITH

MOM - CONTINUED

You have seen every version of me: confident, successful, discouraged, angry, exhausted, rebuilding and, more than once, certain I knew exactly what everyone else should do whether they asked me or not. You have stayed beside me through good years and very low ones. I know I made some events harder because of my attitude. I know there were times when you carried the emotional weight of the family because I was too wrapped up in my own. I also know I have not thanked you nearly enough for the life you helped us build.

We are also, by every measure of the game Compatibility, proof that two people can build a life together while agreeing on almost nothing. We've come in last more holidays than I can count, and I wouldn't trade a single one of those losses.

You untangled the flight changes and brought your steady judgment to the planning. But your real contribution cannot be found on an itinerary. It is the calm and stability you bring into a room. I hope this journey gives you the chance to put down some of the responsibility you normally carry and simply enjoy everything you had a hand in creating.

I love you, I admire you, and I am deeply grateful for everything you have given our family. More than anything, I am grateful for the life we have built together and I don't think I could ever fully put into words what that means to me.



THE PEOPLE I GET TO SHARE THIS WITH

JAY

Jay, you were the little boy who would lie in my arms on the bed and watch Diamondbacks games with me almost every night when we lived in Arizona. You could fall asleep on the boat at Saguaro Lake almost immediately, which was an impressive survival skill in a family that has never been especially quiet.

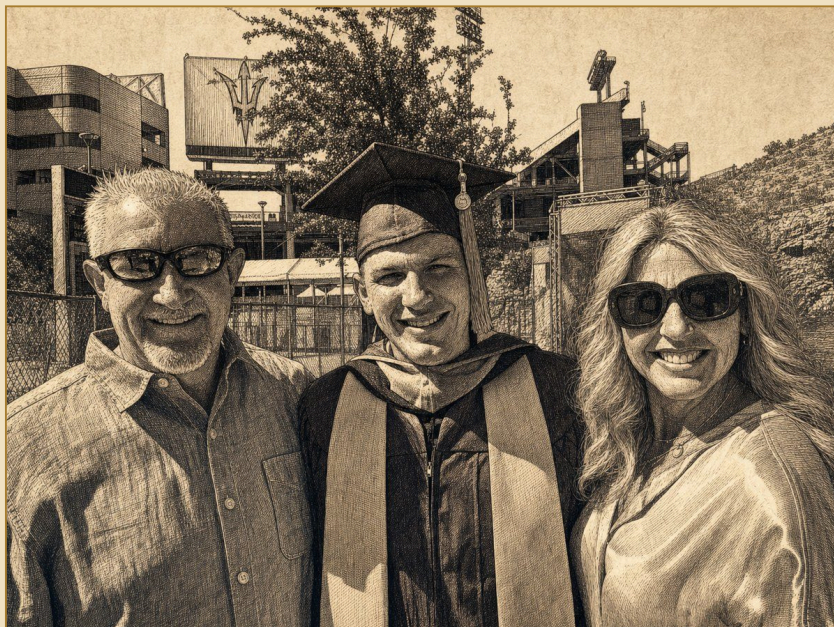
You played baseball and golf, and for years Friday night football meant the same family destination: you on the field, Kea cheering from the sideline, Mom cheering from the stands, and me analyzing every move the two of you made like I was getting paid for it. Those games were never only about a scoreboard. They were part of the rhythm of our family — practices, uniforms, crowded calendars and all four of us sharing the same night from different places around the field.

You are one of the hardest-working and most determined people I know. That showed up early — a summer spent driving to the Blind Guy multiple nights a week, working on a swing most people would've given up adjusting after a few weeks. You didn't.

You also reluctantly helped me with more house projects than any teenager should have to tolerate — tearing out the entryway tile, building the bar in the basement, working on cars you had zero interest in. You didn't want to learn half of it. You learned it anyway, and now you can do things most people just can't.

Not long after you got your license, our yard was soaked, and you missed the driveway entirely in our diesel Ram 2500 — full burnout across the lawn, mud and grass everywhere. That truck was as much yours as mine by then; you'd put in the work turning it into something you actually wanted to drive. You got out, looked at the damage, and gave me a thumbs up. I still have the picture.

You drifted off the edge of the trail and ended up on top of a pine tree that was completely buried in snow, down in a ravine so full of snow it looked like the trail just kept going. You dug the sled out yourself with the one collapsible shovel we had in our arsenal. We'd played cards in the cabin the night before, toured the University of Wyoming and took pictures out on the field, caught a basketball game, and closed it out on your birthday with a steak dinner and a free dessert in Cheyenne. Not a bad way to spend a few days — dug a machine off a buried tree, still had room for dessert on your birthday.



THE PEOPLE I GET TO SHARE THIS WITH

JAY - CONTINUED

Our fishing career has been less impressive. Standing Bear Lake, then Branched Oak once I got the newer boat, then Wanahoo — we pretended we had our own fishing show through all of it, full commentary and everything. We never caught a single thing worth filming. Not once. I'm starting to think the show was the actual point.

The Christmas you came home from Arizona, we went to Bowlers Choice and bought our first bowling balls, shoes and matching bags together. Rich, the pro shop owner, fitted us both that day. That's still ours.

You also have a way of answering a situation with one dry, sarcastic observation that says what everyone else was thinking and makes the whole thing funnier. I am looking forward to that running commentary in London and Scotland, especially when a carefully researched plan encounters weather, transit or four people with four different opinions.

You helped organize this trip, worked through details and gave us plenty of useful feedback. Wembley will be special because of our ASU history and everything sports have meant to us, but it is only one part of what I am excited to share with you. I am looking forward to the history, the golf, the dinners, the travel days and the unplanned conversations — real time with the man you have become.

I am proud of your discipline, your career and your independence. I am also proud of the quieter things — the way you work, the way you follow through, the way people can count on you and the humor you bring without needing to be the loudest person in the room. And, because this is still our family, I remain grateful that the Toe Shake gave the rest of us a story that will outlive whatever dignity you hoped to preserve that evening.

I don't say it enough, so I'm saying it here: I love you, Jay. I'm proud to be your dad.



THE PEOPLE I GET TO SHARE THIS WITH

KEALEY

Kea, this trip begins with us celebrating your twenty-fifth birthday, and I cannot think of a better way for our family journey to start. There are a lot of things I am excited to experience over the next eleven days, but celebrating your birthday together in London is at the top of that list.

You will officially be one-quarter of a century old, which sounds far more alarming than twenty-five and is therefore how I intend to refer to it whenever possible.

You were born the day after 9/11. Nurses gathered in our hospital room to watch television and get updates on what was happening. I will never forget what it felt like to watch the world change while Mom and I waited for you. In the middle of so much fear and sadness, you arrived, and meeting my daughter became one of the greatest moments of my life.

You have never been short on presence. You are strong, direct and willing to stand up for yourself. You do not put up with nonsense, including mine, and you are one of the only people who can make me laugh when I am angry at the world and have decided I do not want to be joyous. Sometimes that requires nothing more than: "Hook, jab, uppercut, boom-boom. Just kidding, boom-boom's not real." It should not work as well as it does, but neither should half of our family humor.

We spent half a Diamondbacks game quietly stacking peanuts on the brim of some stranger's fedora in front of us, trying to see how many we could get up there before they noticed — we never did figure out if it was a man or a woman. I don't remember who won more than I remember not being able to stop laughing.

When I separated my shoulder at the lake, you cut one of my favorite shirts off me just to see how bad it was. Uncle Matt drove me to the hospital, and you and Mom were both there with me the whole time. You were the only one who could get me laughing through that kind of pain, which tells you something about both of us — you don't scare easy, and apparently I can't take an injury seriously even when I should.



THE PEOPLE I GET TO SHARE THIS WITH

KEALEY - CONTINUED

You cheered, played golf, joined a sorority, earned two Arizona State University degrees and built your own accounting career. You also put countless hours into researching this trip and building the spreadsheet that finally made all the pieces fit. Your work gave the rest of us a way to see the whole journey clearly.

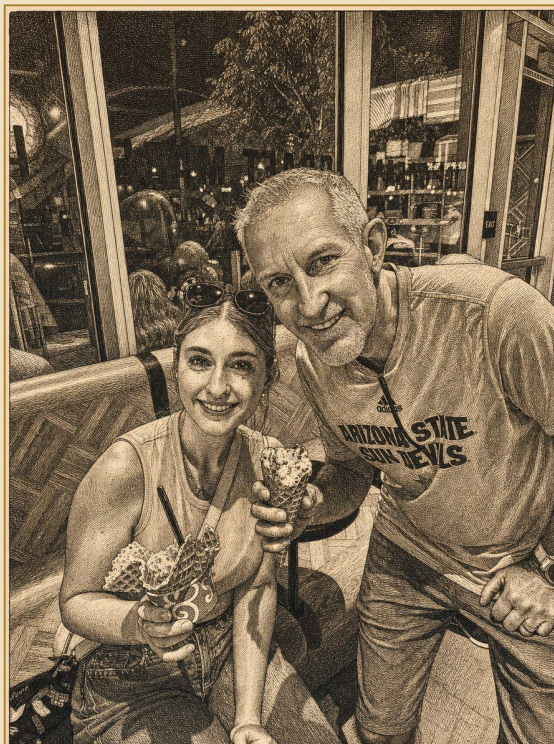
You and I are alike enough to understand one another and alike enough to drive one another completely crazy. Anyone who has watched us attempt an escape room already knows this. I admire your confidence, your intelligence and the fact that you refuse to shrink yourself to make other people comfortable.

You have also grown into someone I genuinely enjoy spending time with. Beneath the confidence and strong opinions is a person who cares deeply about the people she loves, and I hope you know how much I value the relationship we have now that you are an adult. We can argue, compete, give each other a hard time and occasionally discover that putting the two of us in charge of the same problem was a tactical mistake, but there is nobody else quite like you.

And then there are Mango and Pearle, your rescued babies. You gave both of them a home, and in return they have become deeply loved members of your little family while contributing absolutely nothing financially. Between them and Cosmo, this family now supports three completely unemployed freeloaders who all act entitled to the position.

I am proud of you, and I hope your birthday in London feels like a celebration not only of the day you were born, but of the woman you have become. Twenty-five years went much faster than I ever imagined they would. Getting to spend this one together, halfway around the world with all four of us, is something I know I will remember long after the trip is over.

I know we'll find something to argue about before this trip is over — we always do. But underneath it, I am so proud of you, I love you more than you probably know, and there's nobody else I'd rather have in my corner. Hook, jab, uppercut — boom-boom.





SOMEONE HAS TO STAY HOME

COSMO

Cosmo turned four in February, which makes her the youngest member of this family by a fairly significant margin and, depending on whom you ask, possibly Mom's current favorite child.

Once Jay and Kea built lives of their own and Mom and I officially became empty nesters, Cosmo made certain the transition would not become too quiet. She is Mom's latest baby, constant companion and a very effective reason the house never actually feels empty.

She does not have two Arizona State University degrees, a career or particularly useful opinions about this trip, but she has managed to establish a level of household importance the rest of us spent years earning.

She will not be crossing the Atlantic with us, but she is part of the home we are leaving and one of the reasons coming back will feel good. I suspect Mom will begin missing her before the plane leaves Phoenix. I am equally certain that Cosmo's reunion with Mom will receive more enthusiasm than most human arrivals ever have.



YOU GUYS

LOVE WITHOUT CONDITIONS

Jay and Kea, both of you earned two degrees from Arizona State, including your master's degrees, and built careers and lives of your own in Scottsdale. Those accomplishments belong to you. Mom and I may have encouraged, pushed, worried and offered opinions with varying levels of usefulness, but you did the work.

Before anything else, I want both of you to understand something I may not have made clear enough while you were growing up: you never had to earn my love or my pride. I may have focused too often on the next goal, the next result or what I thought you could become, but being your dad was already one of the greatest gifts of my life.

I was hard on both of you when you were growing up. Part of me believed that if I pushed you hard enough, life would never be able to surprise you with something harder.

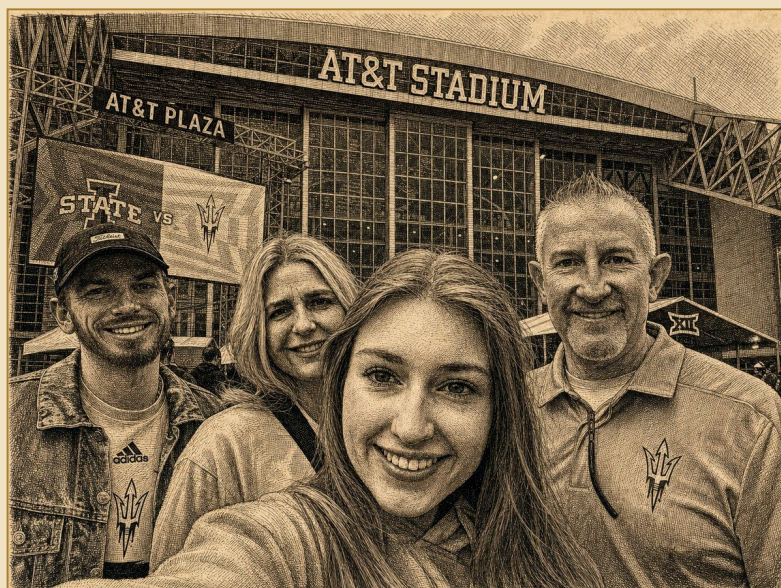
When I looked back on my own golf career, I sometimes wished I had been more tenacious about seeing how far I could take it. I let that regret influence how hard I pushed both of you. I wanted you to recognize your ability, pursue your goals with confidence and never wonder whether you had left something unfinished. My intentions came from love and belief in you, even when I did not always find the right balance.

I know my pressure sometimes came without enough warmth. I relied on Mom to be the nurturing parent while I focused on driving you forward. I know that may have created resentment, and I am sorry. I cannot rewrite those years, and I do not expect one trip or one letter to make up for them.

I wish I had shown you more often that I was proud of you even when there was nothing to win, improve or accomplish. You deserved that balance from me.

What I can do is be honest, take responsibility and keep getting better. I hope some of the strength and persistence I tried to teach you helped. I also understand now that strength grows better when people feel loved, safe and celebrated while they are building it.

I am immensely proud of both of you, not only for what you have achieved, but for who you are. I love you both more deeply than I have sometimes managed to show. No accomplishment of mine will ever mean more than being your dad, and no title I have ever held will make me prouder.



NOT A RESOLUTION, A PROMISE

ONE HONEST THING

I know I have not always been easy to live with.

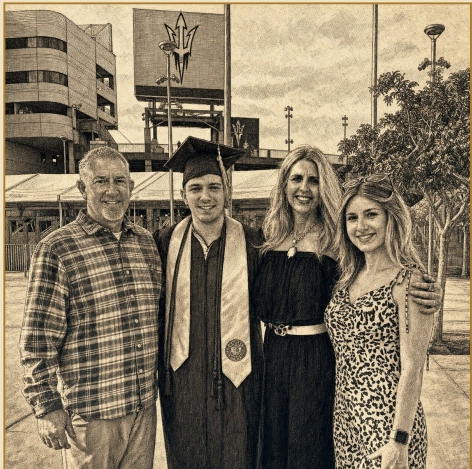
I can push too hard. I can get so focused on making something successful that I forget the people around me are supposed to enjoy it. I can bring frustration home and make a good moment smaller because I cannot get out of my own way. There have been times when my attitude changed the feeling of an event for everyone else. I know that, and I am working on it.

There have also been times when I gave everything I knew how to give to make life better for the people around me, even when I was not taking very good care of myself. I have loved this family fiercely, and I have not always expressed that love in the way you needed to receive it.

I do not want this trip to feel like eleven days of being evaluated, directed or asked whether everyone is properly appreciating the itinerary. I do not want anyone studying my mood or wondering whether a changed plan will ruin the day. I want us to laugh, talk, notice things and have spontaneous moments no spreadsheet could have predicted.

I want you guys to feel how much I love you and how proud I am of you without having to search for the message underneath my intensity. I want Mom to enjoy the trip without carrying everyone else. I want Jay to know I value the entire journey we get to share, not just Wembley. I want Kea to feel celebrated in a way worthy of the birthday that helps begin it all.

I am not asking the trip to repair the past. I am asking myself to be present for the future. That means putting the plan down when the moment matters more, laughing when something goes sideways and remembering that the people beside me are always more important than the schedule in front of me.





WHAT I HOPE WE BRING HOME

More than anything, I hope this trip gives us time together filled with laughter and memories we will never forget. I hope it gives us conversations we might not have at home, spontaneous moments that belong only to us and a better understanding of how much I care about each of you.

I hope we learn enough history to see more than buildings. I hope golf gives us a reason to slow down at Musselburgh, Gullane and St Andrews. I hope Wembley is every bit as loud and unreasonable as it should be. I hope we eat a few exceptional meals and at least one thing somebody immediately regrets ordering.

I also hope we recognize how fortunate we are. We have the health, time and opportunity to cross an ocean together. We have people waiting for us at home. Most importantly, after all the years, changes, mistakes and difficult seasons, we still have one another. I believe that is a gift from God, and I do not want us to move so quickly through the trip that we forget to be thankful for it.

Years from now, we may remember St Andrews, Westminster Abbey or the Wembley arch. But knowing this family, the story that survives may involve a missed train, a ridiculous argument or someone putting a body part into a beverage.

Whatever it is, it will be ours.

I love you guys. I am proud of you. And I am incredibly grateful that the next chapter belongs to the four of us.

